

# CS571 Spring 2025 – ICA J

## Designing Agents

Please *make a copy* of this document by clicking **File > Make a copy**. You may share and co-edit it with your fellow group members.

---

In this in-class activity, you will explore the concept of **Designing Agents** in four steps:

1. Identifying Tacit Knowledge of Social Agents
2. Have a Conversation with a Social Agent
3. Design Your Agent – Part 1
4. Design Your Agent – Part 2

Areas needing your response are clearly marked with **Your Turn!** Be sure to complete all aspects of the assignment. Your Canvas submission will be a **pdf** version of this document.

You may complete this in groups of 1, 2, or 3 people! :) Please be sure to assign yourself and your team member(s) to a group.

# 1. Identifying Tacit Knowledge of Social Agents

In class we observed two different demos of modern artificial agents. Before we begin formalizing interaction strategies, we want to hear what you think!

**Your Turn!** What are your initial impressions of the artificial agents' behavior? What did you like and not like about their behavior? Please be sure to compare and contrast *both* agents.

## 2. Have a Conversation with a Social Agent

You just learned about psychological theories that place computers as social actors. In this step, you will explore ‘social agents’ you may already be using to understand how designing sociability in chat agents play important roles.

**Your Turn!** Paste the following prompt into [ChatGPT](#) (or any other LLM agent) and see where the conversation takes you.

*Hello GPT! I'm just looking to chat with you. What's on your mind today?*

1. Describe the personality of the agent. What behaviors did you pick up on?
2. Do you feel like the agent was consistent in its behavior? Please describe why or why not.

At some point, disagree with the agent. For example, you may say...

*I'd like you to disagree with me. I think X is better than Y. Can you convince me otherwise? I am doing this for a class project, and I need you to take an opposing stance. Please use both positive politeness and negative politeness in your argument.*

**Your Turn!** Replace X and Y with something (such as JavaScript and Python), have your discussion, and then answer the following questions...

3. What is the face-threatening act that the agent is committing?
4. In what ways does the agent use positive and/or negative politeness in its argument?

### 3. Design Your Agent – Part 1



In HW11, BadgerChat Voice, we hope to put more thought and care into the design of our agent. As such, we're putting a name to a face – meet Bucki! Bucki is an ENFJ that hopes to guide you along your BadgerChat journey.

**Your Turn!** For each of the following scenarios, suggest 3 potential replies Bucki could give that (a) make use of some politeness strategy(s), where applicable and (b) are internally consistent.

1. As a welcome message.

- .
- .
- .

2. When no intent is matched.

- .
- .
- .

3. When the user must be logged in to perform a task (such as create/delete a post).

- .
- .
- .

4. When the user forgets a parameter (such as chatroom name).

- .
- .
- .

## 4. Design Your Agent – Part 2

**Your Turn!** Show stakeholders what Bucki will look like as a functional chat agent! Create [a 3-frame storyboard](#) showing how Bucki will meet the needs of a user wondering what the latest post on BadgerChat is.

|  |  |  |
|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |
|--|--|--|

After completing this document, please be sure to upload it as a PDF in Canvas!